# Pine Valley Special Services District ("PVSSD")

## Meeting Minutes

*Pine Valley Fire Station, 680 East Main Street, Conference Room*

## Wednesday, April 8, 2026

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| Board Members: | Bob Dalley, Chairman<br>Emily Neilson, Vice-Chair<br>Mark Owens<br>Steve Shakespeare |
| PVSSD Assistants: | Rick Peetz, Clerk<br>Teri Forbes, Treasurer |
| Fire Chief: | Robert Hardy (via Zoom) |
| Others: | Marge Shakespeare<br>Scott Dunkleman<br>Claudia Davis<br>Duane Krohn<br>Audrey Krohn<br>John Robson<br>Rosemary D'Amato<br>Brad Esposito<br>John Nichols<br>Frank Davie<br>Cindy Galt |

**1. Welcome – Chairman Bob Dalley.**

Chair Bob Dalley called the meeting to order at 6:45 PM.

**2. Meeting Minutes.**

**A. Approval of the March 11, 2026, PVSSSD Meeting Minutes.**

**Allen Cannon moved to APPROVE the minutes of March 11, 2026. Emily Neilson seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

**3. U.S. Forest Service Report – Joe Rechsteiner.**

There was no report.

**4. Update on Flooding and Mitigation Efforts – Mark Owens.**

## 5. Report on Work Taking Place on the Dam – Mark Owens.

The above two items were discussed together.

Mark reported on the following:

- The previous day, there was a mandatory pre-bid meeting for the Emergency Watershed Protection ("EWP") Project with 14 contractors in attendance. The bid date is April 16 with a May 1 start date. Mark expected that work on the Water and Sediment Control Basins ("WASCOB") in Forsyth would be the first completed. Any work on the river will be done last due to fish habitat. The estimated cost associated with the scope of work is $1.1 million and is to be paid by the federal government.
- Firewood will be made available from materials from the WASCOB sites. The contractor will remove the trees but the community can cut it up and haul it away.
- With regard to the campground, the County is working to come up with the funding to dredge the reservoir. The contractor cannot give away that material.
- It was noted that 80,000 trees have been planted in the area.
- The Heritage Center will be closed for the season but the picnic area will be open to the public.
- A service group is proposing to plant 250 trees south of Pinecone and Cliff Rose. The Dinner Committee is still discussing what to do with the funds raised.
- The dam is expected to open at the end of 2027. Mark expected it to be dredged down six feet, with the dredged material to be taken to the bone yard. The government will then have the option of deciding what to do with it. It will be used as a borrowing source for the EWP project as well.
- The US Forest Service expressed its appreciation to the community for the service rendered at the Heritage Center. Other volunteer opportunities will be forthcoming.

Rosemary D'Amato asked if the dredged material will be made available to the Garden Club for use in gardens. She also suggested that photos be provided and the story told and made public.

Scott Dunkleman asked about the most recent storm and stated that it caused damage in town. He asked if anyone could verify whether seeding was taking place at the same time. Emily commented that that is well beyond the scope of the board.

Mark reported that he made arrangements for Joe Rechsteiner to be in the valley during critical phases. In the meantime, Mark will be provided with updates.

Frank Davie reported that he and his wife, Maxine, have a friend who is a beekeeper who has seedlings that he would like to donate. Mark offered to provide him with two contacts.

## 6. Local Governments Trust Training – Allen Cannon.

Allen reported that the trust serves as a membership for professional development in public service, which is not applicable to the work of the PVSSD. It is very involved, intense, and costly. In addition, it is not something the PVSSD is required to do. He recommended that the board not address it further.

## 7. HB-48 Update – Chair Dalley.

Chair Dalley reported that a community meeting was held a few weeks earlier with the Fire Warden. An email was received from Victoria Hales with the County Attorney's Office that indicates that inspections will be postponed. It was thought that much of the effect of the bill was put on hold until January 2027.

HB-48 addresses Wildland Urban Interface issues and a significant portion of Pine Valley has been exposed. Areas south of Main Street are most impacted and are considered high risk. At some point, there will be an opportunity for inspections and property evaluations. There will also be associated fees. If a property owner refuses an inspection, there could be a rating resulting in a high-high classification. Many are still trying to figure out the intent of the bill. Chair Dalley's understanding was that it is an effort to manage insurance costs.

Allen commented that it appears that the fee structure is intended to mitigate costs that the state and federal government are absorbing to fight wildfires. As a result, they are putting more of the onus on those who reside in exposed areas.

The Pine Valley Fire Department has offered to conduct consultations with property owners on ways to be more fire-wise. Currently, about one dozen homeowners have requested that service.

## 8. Fire Department Report – Fire Captain, Brad Esposito.

Brad reported that in March, the Fire Department had nine callouts. Eight were in Central and one in Pine Valley. 39 response hours were reported, 207 hours of training, and 156 service hours for a total of 402 hours for the month. The year-to-date hours reported were 1,051 for the year compared to 1,185 last year.

Approximately 60 people were in attendance at the recent HB-48 meeting. Brad stated that if there are items on a property that need to be cleaned up, the Fire Department can provide assistance. The County has also offered to bring in a wood chipper on certain dates. Chair Dalley was informed by the Fire Warden that they can accommodate logs of up to four inches in diameter.

Brad stated that the Fire Department drone has arrived, but they are waiting for the registration paperwork from the Federal Aviation Administration ("FAA"). They have also obtained a quote for full coverage insurance for the drone in the amount of $2,472 per year. The bid was received from the Utah Local Governments Trust, which handles the insurance. Brad noted that the replacement cost of the drone is $24,000.

Emily asked if there was a plan to have other volunteers get certified as pilots. Brad stated that Chief Hardy and Steve Shakespeare have their pilot licenses. The drone will be registered through the Fire Department under a Certificate of Authority ("COA"), which allows anyone to fly it as long as there is a licensed pilot on scene.

In response to a question raised, Brad indicated that he is working on Standard Operating Guidelines that will be submitted to the board once complete. Currently, the drone is kept in a secure location at the fire station.

Rick stated that the cost of insurance was not budgeted for and will require a budget amendment. Brad indicated that the drone will not be flown until it is insured.

Allen asked about the video retention associated with the drone. Brad explained that the drone has a 256G memory card. Every time he is on an incident, he downloads the footage into files on his desktop and deletes the footage from the drone. The chip in the drone can record 50 to 60 hours of video. The flying capability of the drone is only 60 to 90 minutes.

Mark asked if there was any surplus value to the old fan to help offset the insurance cost. Brad stated that the old fan is gas-powered and questioned whether it has much value.

Mark reported that last month, Emily mentioned exterior lighting on the fire station and suggested that it come into compliance. The board was informed

that the new lighting will be installed later this year. He asked if there was a budget for that. Emily stated that the lighting on the station was grandfathered in. Her suggestion was to set a good example. If an estimate could be provided, she would help do some community fundraising, as it was not budgeted for. She would not want money to come from the Fire Department's safety budget. Brad stated that the matter has been discussed at their Officers' Meeting and they plan to complete the work this year. The dark skylights that are downlit cost $60 to $70 each, with 12 needed. He offered to install them at no cost. An immediate resolution would be to install bulbs with lower wattage now.

Chair Dalley suggested that the additional $1,000 for lights be combined with the $2,500 sought for insurance.

Frank Davie thanked Brad and Gun Wastland for replacing the lights in the fire bays free of charge. Brad reported that the former fluorescent lights were very dim, and several had bad ballasts, which would have cost $100 each to replace. They were instead converted to new lights that emit 24,000 lumens of light and use only 12 watts of electricity. The cost was $1,200, which was budgeted for under repairs. In terms of safety, it was noted that it is much better for the Fire Department.

**9. Clerk and Treasurer's Reports (March) – Rick Peetz and Teri Forbes.**

Teri presented the Treasurer's Report and indicated that she balanced the bank accounts and found all to be in order.

Rick presented the Clerk's Report and reported on significant expenditures, including vehicle repairs. There was a $1,300 expenditure for a radio change between ambulances, as well as a repair on the tender and Brush 145. Under Communications and Radios, there was an expense for the new phone that was purchased for the station to be used with the monitor in the form of a one-year prepaid service contract. It also allows the PVSSD to set up its own Venmo account.

Rick noted that the recent Fire Fee mailings cost $700 for postage.

The recent costs of supplies for the ambulance were due to items that had expired and needed to be replaced. With regard to fuel reimbursements, Mark asked that a name be associated with each along with the vehicle. The $103 fuel cost was for the large engine and was payable to Brackens. He asked that the information be provided in the future.

Chief Hardy reported that a limited number of people are authorized to charge for fuel at Brackens. All have been instructed that the vehicle identification go on the invoice. He would ensure that the process is being followed going forward and that Brackens is putting the needed information on the invoice.

Chair Dalley referenced the balance sheet and the Venmo line item. Account 6138 is the PV Fire Recovery and is the residual from the amounts collected from donations. At some point, a decision needs to be made about what to do with the funds. He suggested that it be discussed. One option was to transfer it to the PVLAD for tree planning or other mitigation work in the area. Emily liked the idea of including it in the charitable group and the Dinner Committee so that it benefits everyone in the community and not just one homeowner. Mark expressed his support and asked that the matter be on the next agenda for discussion.

The Board next discussed the Venmo account, and concerns were expressed about Venmo being used for the Annual Assessment. In the past, there was a connection to personal phone numbers, which has since been corrected. A cell phone was obtained that will be used on the ambulance to send critical information to the hospital while the ambulance is en route. The phone number is also connected to the Venmo Account. The account is now connected to the Fire Department with Teri having full access. The Venmo is linked to the PVSSD bank accounts.

Rick reported that thus far, $60,775 has been collected, with about $10,000 paid through Venmo.

Rick reported that this is the time of year when he moves money from the Operational Fund to an interest-bearing account. The Mental Health Account has no balance but was used previously for funds received from the County in the form of a Mental Health Grant. Those funds have since been expended.

Rose D'Amato noted that they use an outside source to print and mail invoices, which saves them money. Rick asked to be provided with the information. The potential of taking credit card payments was discussed.

**Allen Cannon moved to APPROVE the Clerk and Treasurer's Reports. Mark Owens seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

## 10. Quarterly Reconciliation Report - Chair Dalley and Allen Cannon.

Chair Dalley reported that he met with Rick and Teri the previous day and conducted the Quarterly Reconciliation Report that is part of the Fraud Risk

Assessment. He reviewed each account and found each to be reconciled properly.

## 11. Update on County Audit – Chair Dalley, Rick, and Teri.

An email was received from County Auditor, Susan Lewis, who provided a draft report asking for comments. Chair Dalley considered it a very good report that was complementary of the board's policy and procedures and found to be in compliance with those policies. She provided the following suggestions and observations :

- She claimed that a single check was written and signed by Rick Peetz, which was not the case. He is not a signator and does not sign checks. The only signators on the account last year were Allen Cannon, Mary Esther Putnam, LaDawn Christensen, and Teri Forbes.
- She claimed that the board does not always show the budget to actual, which is incorrect.
- She reviewed the Fraud and Risk Assessment and provided the assessment from the PVLAD Board in error.

Ms. Lewis' suggestions were as follows:

- Post the County Ombudsman Hotline on the website. Chair Dalley agreed to do that.
- Consider a Purchase Card for specific transactions to reduce the number of checks written. The use of a Purchase Card was of concern with respect to controls. The pros and cons were discussed.

Chief Hardy was asked if he had received complaints about reimbursements from Fire Department personnel. He stated that it has been the opposite, with many preferring to use their own card. He supported a Purchase Card because there are monthly costs that individuals are being reimbursed for.

Chair Dalley reported that he spent most of his career as a Controller or a CFO, and does not like Purchase Cards because there are opportunities for misuse. Emily suggested the possibility of a hybrid that could be used for ongoing expenses. Various options were discussed. Allen asked to be provided with the number of recurring costs per month, where reimbursements are made, and the amounts. Rick offered to report back next month.

Chair Dalley indicated that he and Allen have performed the internal audit. The full board serves as an informal audit committee by reviewing the financials each month. He was not opposed to forming an Audit Committee. Emily stated that they should perhaps change how they answer Question 9 on

the Fraud Assessment, which specifically asks if they have a formal Audit Committee.

Chair Dalley noted that Ms. Lewis has been thorough in conducting the audit. Mark stated that there has been no finding of wrongdoing in the review process. He suggested that once formalized, the report be posted on the website where the public can review it.

## 12. Update on Community Center Meeting with County – Allen Cannon.

Allen reported that he and Mark have had discussions with County Commissioner Gil Almquist and Joe Rechsteiner. The US Forest Service is waiting for a letter to be drafted by Victoria Hales. He provided her with information regarding what has taken place over the last 2 ½ to 3 years. Ms. Hales will hopefully now be prepared to draft a letter to the US Forest Service regarding the acquisition of the property. In response to a question raised, Allen stated that they were initially looking to purchase five of the nine acres. That may change based on the remediation appraisal and cost. The US Forest Service goes through a process to determine valuation, and the County determines how and where the money comes from. So far, the County has used $1,000,000 of for remediation costs.

In response to questions regarding the balance of the property, the County may want the five acres, and the US Forest Service may no longer want to manage small parcels of property. If that is the case, the County could recommend that they donate the property that the fire station sits on, rather than the County having to acquire it. Chair Dalley explained that the PVSSD currently has a long-term lease that Mary Esther Putnam renewed 6 to 8 years ago for 50 years. Steve Shakespeare stated that, based on conversations he has had over the years, the US Forest Service would prefer the County to own it. He did not expect any development to take place until the County makes a trade.

## 13. State Auditor Training.

Chair Dalley reported that each Board Member should have received notice of an Auditor Training scheduled for April 24th. Rick stated that a follow-up letter was sent, indicating that, due to the number of participants, they do not want anyone to attend other than those directly involved in that process. He and Teri planned to attend. Chair Dalley asked that Rick and Teri provide a report at the next meeting.

## 14. Citizen Requests.

John Robson thanked the Board for the excellent job they do.

Frank Davie reported that they use Purchase Cards at the Family History Center and it has been a very efficient process.

Rosemary D'Amato suggested that the cash back be used toward those experiencing hardship.

There were no further citizen requests.

## 15. Other Business.

There was no Other Business.

## 16. Adjournment.

**Allen Cannon moved to ADJOURN. The motion was seconded by Emily Neilson. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Board.**

The meeting adjourned at 8:02 PM.

The next PVSSD meeting will be on Wednesday, May 13, 2026.